The Creative Problem-Solving Tool Kit

Opening your life to infinite possibilities

by
Max Benda and
Win Wenger

A Project Renaissance CoreBook

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To Donna & Gerd

Preface

PROJECT RENAISSANCE is an educational organization dedicated to empowering individuals to become more than a match for the situations, opportunities and problems or difficulties that they find around them, and to enjoy a richer quality of life and experience.

Project Renaissance publishes books, a monthly newsletter, *The Stream*, the online *Winsights* column by Win Wenger, and new research on its website, **www.winwenger.com**.

Project Renaissance helped to create, and participates in, **imagestream@yahoogroups.com**, the highly active list group, where thousands of members exchange ideas, information, points of inquiry, energies and mutual encouragement.

Project Renaissance also offers workshops, seminars, training courses and conferences throughout the world and at various times of the year. Project Renaissance's annual conference draws students and trainers from all over the world and is a Double Festival of Creative Problem-Solving and Accelerated Learning,

The volumes in this series of CoreBooks encompass the essential principles and practices of Project Renaissance and are derived from the research and writings of Win Wenger, Ph.D.

Other publications from Project Renaissance:

The CoreBook series
Image-Streaming
Super Skills for Students
End Writer's Block Forever
Dynamic Teaching
The Creative Problem-Solving Tool Kit
and more to come

Selected books by Win Wenger
The Einstein Factor (with Richard Poe)
Beyond OK
Beyond Teaching and Learning
Discovering the Obvious
How to Increase Your Intelligence
A Method for Personal Growth and Development
and many others

Audio courses published by Nightingale-Conant
Brain Boosters
The Einstein Factor (with Richard Poe)

Audio course published by Learning Strategies Corp.
The Genius Code (with Paul Scheele)

E-books and reviews on
www.winwenger.com

Acknowledgments

Several years ago, I attended my first Project Renaissance Double Festival. In an Image-Streaming exercise, I had an image of 3 books that I had written related to Win's work. The first one was published in 2007, *Dynamic Teaching*. Here is the second. The effort has been a family affair. My wife, Maiya, and my parents, Donna and Gerd, provided suggestions and ideas to make my writing clearer. My sons, Branden and Jeremy, spent many hours at Karate, allowing me time to write. My daughters, Katie and Lizzy, understood my need for quiet to write.

Thanks to Win for giving me the opportunity to write this book with him. A special thanks to Kate Jones for editing and overseeing the birth of this book.

—*Max Benda*

About Max Benda

Max Benda is a writer with a passion for exploring ways to maximize human potential and creativity. His company, The Benda Group, provides coaching and consulting. Email him at max@maxbenda.com.

About Win Wenger

Win Wenger, Ph.D., is a pioneer in the fields of creativity and creative method, accelerated learning, Socratic method, brain and mind development, and political economy. This book is based on his most outstanding creativity and problem-solving methods.

Formerly a college teacher, Dr. Wenger is a trainer renowned around the world, and the author of over 50 published books, including his breakthrough text of techniques to facilitate scientific discovery and technical invention, *Discovering the Obvious*. His official website is www.winwenger.com.

His main text of education-related and growth techniques is *Beyond Teaching and Learning*, and his most widely popular work, *The Einstein Factor*, co-authored with Richard Poe, is available in good bookstores near you. Synopses of his work, and special articles on it, have frequently appeared in *Success* Magazine, one of the world's leading entrepreneurial monthlies.

Foreword

Stop for a moment and think about an apple.

What did you experience?

Was it a picture of an apple? Was it the word “apple”? Did you think an apple a day keeps the doctor away? Was it a symphony of sensations, smells, tastes, pictures, and sounds complemented by emotion?

Most people notice only a fraction of their thoughts consciously. Each of us has hundreds of thoughts and streams of perception going on at the same time, and we usually never notice them.

Think about an apple again, but this time, when you think about it, imagine being an apple hanging on a tree.

- ✓ Are you sweet or sour?
- ✓ Feel connected to the tree through the stem.

Experience the:

- ✓ Heat from the sun
- ✓ Wind blowing
- ✓ Red coloring
- ✓ Bugs flying around and landing on you
- ✓ Smell of the air
- ✓ Taste of the rain
- ✓ Sound of birds chirping

What differences do you notice between the first time you thought about an apple and the second time?

The majority of people use the verbal portion of their brain to think about an apple the first time. The second time we encouraged using sensory images.

So, how does this exercise relate to your life?

The purpose of the exercise is to point out that no matter how successful, brilliant, smart, rich, loving, creative, caring, _____ (fill in the blank) you are today, if you are not using your sensory imagery to find answers, you are operating at a fraction of what you could. It is estimated that approximately 2% of the brain's processing uses words and 60 to 90% of the processing is done using sensory imagery.

By doing the exercises in this book, you will discover, experience, and explore the sensory images that are usually just outside of your conscious awareness. In your sensory images, you will find an abundance of information, ideas, possibilities and answers.

By describing what you are experiencing out loud, you ground the images and unlock a new dimension of yourself that allows the "A-HA!" answers to whatever you are trying to solve, invent, create or understand.

The more you use the exercises, the more your thinking will incorporate sensory images. You will have access to more possibilities and your responses to the problems and challenges you encounter will be different.

It starts with you

It sounds obvious as we write it, but doing the exercises and becoming aware of your sensory thinking starts with you. By paying attention and fully describing your experience, you will

discover your own answers based on your life experience. Others may want to interpret what you are describing to them. Listen and realize that their answers are usually not your answers.

Many times we get stuck repeating what we know about a problem to ourselves and others. To succeed in solving a problem, we need to move beyond what we know and into fresh perceptions where we can find the best answer. Paying attention to what our senses are telling us can shift how we understand the problem and help us solve it.

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The Creative Problem-Solving Tool Kit

Introduction

Did you know?

It wasn't until World War II that the belief that people are born creative or not came into question. Due to the desperate war conditions, there weren't enough people available to meet the needs of industry and the war effort. The same designers, scientists, engineers and R&D specialists had to serve on three or four different production teams at the same time.

An interesting pattern began to emerge. On one production team a person would be highly creative. On another team, the same person would be totally uncreative. The war ended before any inquiry into creativity could show conclusively whether one was born creative or not.

After the war, a similar phenomenon emerged when television developed as a means of mass marketing. Suddenly, there was a demand for more marketing talent than there were "creative" people. Once more, people found themselves on multiple teams.

Once again, a person who was a creative giant on one team was totally uncreative on another team. Perhaps because of the monetary stakes, companies began looking into the revolutionary possibility that it wasn't whether a person was born creative or not, but what circumstances caused a person to be creative on one team and uncreative on another.

The research found that a person's working conditions could turn creativity on or off. The research also showed that the working conditions of nearly all Americans at that time reduced creativity. Making changes in the working conditions could improve creativity.

Soon hundreds of creativity methods and systems were available. Of these hundreds of techniques, we have selected a relative handful that are especially effective, simple to learn and easy to use.

Guidelines Section

The Creative Problem-Solving Tool Kit helps you solve problems, invent, make discoveries, understand complex material, teach and much more, by helping you develop your use of sensory imagery and the power of describing your perceptions. There is no one "correct" way to do the exercises, because we each think and approach the world differently.

The following guidelines help you get started, provide suggestions for working with partners effectively, and offer suggestions for verifying the answers you find. The guidelines are based on experience of working with many thousands of people.

Getting started

1. Do the exercises in whatever order appeals to you. Try each at least once.

2. Complete the "Journal Questions" to help ground your experience and help you discover more.

3. Work with a partner or an audio recorder whenever possible. If you are in a public place and don't want to speak out loud, do the exercises and write down the information. [It is more important to do the exercises than to worry about getting the form exactly right.]

4. Discover your own answers.

5. Have fun.

Note: Whenever possible, develop your perceptions by describing them aloud to an external listener or recorder. Describing your perceptions only to yourself, in your head, simply does not develop those perceptions.

Providing feedback

As we put the book out into the world, it is like putting a bottle with a message into the ocean. We want to get a response.

We want to hear how the exercises have benefitted you, your life and your world. Please let us know.

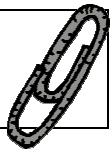
Our goal is to produce a book each year of how people have used the exercises in this book to make a meaningful positive difference in their lives, in the lives of those around them, and in their community and in our larger community which we call "the world."

We are also interested in hearing about any issues or problems that you encounter with the techniques.

Let us know your experiences.

- ✓ Max can be reached at max@maxbenda.com
- ✓ Win can be reached at: wwenger101@aol.com

Please paper clip or fold down the corner of this page for easy reference.



Why work with a partner?

A partner can provide a big difference in your results. With a live listener, the likelihood of success increases.

With a partner, we tend to provide more complete descriptions because our partner might have to ask for clarification. We also pay more attention to what we say when we have a live listener and we hear ourselves differently.

An observant partner will notice phrases or ideas that you repeat even when you edit what you are going to say. A partner can keep you focused on your goal when the describing starts to slow down.

A logistical benefit of a partner is that he or she can guide you through the exercises.

If you cannot find a partner when you are ready to do one of the techniques, a recorder will work. If you don't have a recorder, write the information down.

In our experiencing, just speaking the information to yourself in your head is almost guaranteed to result in failure.

How to work with a partner

These simple guidelines help make working with a partner more fun and productive.

If you are the listener:

1. Make sure the speaker feels he or she is truly being heard.
2. Focus completely on him or her.
3. If need be, ask clarifying questions to help him or her explore his or her own ideas.
4. Avoid offering your own insights even if you are sure you know the answer.

The person who owns the question or problem is the one to come up with the answer. Help your partner discover his or her own answer.

If you are the speaker:

1. Do not repeat yourself more than you absolutely have to.
2. Keep finding fresh things to say about the issue. Repeating the same words keeps you stuck where you are. For different results, say something different.
3. Pay more attention to your immediate sensory perceptions (body feelings, emotions, images, sounds…) and less to what you "know" about the situation.

The person who owns the question or problem is the one to come up with the answer.

Creating a Goal or Problem Statement

1. Select a problem or goal in your personal life, your job, your career, your community, your nation or world that you would really like to find the answer to.

2. Ask open-ended questions such as, "What's the best way to _____?" Open-ended questions are questions that *cannot* be answered merely with a "yes" or a "no" answer.

3. Ask win-win questions such as, “How do I get a salary increase and provide the company more value without working more hours?” With win-win questions, everyone involved wins.

Describing your sensory imagery is one of the skills that you will develop doing the exercises. At first, it may seem uncomfortable because you may not be used to describing your sensory imagery out loud. We have included some guidelines to help you develop your skill.

Another very good activity you can do frequently or systematically is to pay attention to your perceptions, especially to those thoughts that pop up and then are gone.We have included what we call *Journal Questions* for you to capture your thoughts and perceptions about what you are learning.

Describing Sensory Imagery

1. Pretend that you are a radio reporter "painting word pictures" of the sensory images all around you.

2. Help your listener see, feel, smell, taste and experience the utter reality of the images, through your description.

3. Describe your first impression (picture, feeling, sound, smell, taste) regardless of whether or not it seems related to what you are working on.

4. Continue describing the images in richly textured detail as if you were still looking at them, even if you just got a glimpse. More will come as you describe it.

5. Keep describing even when you feel like you have nothing left to say. Just keep talking.

6, Use the present tense while describing. Stay in the present tense even though the experience may be in your recent past. For example, if you are debriefing from an exercise, you would say, "I am looking at all this ripe wheat bending in the wind," not, "I was looking...."

Journal Questions:
We have included the *Journal Questions* to help you focus on your perceptions. Frequently we take in information and don't get the time to process it or ground it in our experience.

- What would stand in your way to paint word pictures?

(MB—I don't tend to pay attention to the level of detail required to paint word pictures.)

- What could you do to start painting word pictures if you don't already?

(MB—I started trying to describe the colors in the sunrises on my commute to the office.)

Finding meaning in the answers

As noted earlier, approximately 2% of the brain's processing capacity uses words and 60 to 90% is done using sensory imagery. Operating languages of the sensory majority and the verbal minority are as different as a dream and a technical government report.

For most issues and problems, the answer is likely to be a metaphor that relates to your life experience. It may take some effort to figure it out consciously. The information is not coded to make it difficult to figure out, but to find a metaphor which can convey the same meaning in both languages of the brain,

sensory *and* verbal. As you develop your skill with the techniques, your "A-HA!" answers will show up more often while you are doing the exercise.

The most important thing is to decide on your answer *after you've let the whole experience unfold, and after you've described it in detail.*

Here are several ways to improve your chances of finding the meaning behind your images:

- Use richly textured sensory detail in your descriptions.

- When describing, speak as fast as possible to avoid editing what you are going to say.

- Engage more of your awareness in the experience including sight, touch, smell, movement, space, pressure, mass, temperature, texture, taste, atmospheric feel, and sound.

- Question objects in the experience, asking, "Why are you here in this experience?" "What role do you play in this answer?" Observe and describe how the scene changes or what else happens in response.

- Ask your subtler faculties to help you understand the answer by showing you the same answer to that same question again, but through an entirely different scene. Usually, three very different scenes displaying the same answer are enough to let you infer the meaning from their common elements. (Using multiple scenes to get an answer does not need to take a lot of time.)

Journal Question:

- What are some of the many ways you can engage more of your senses?

Trust the answers you receive—but verify

Even when an answer comes through with the certainty of the "Word of God," it is a human instrument receiving them. Verify things as you go.

Depending on the amount of risk associated with the answer you receive, it pays to check your answer against other sources. If you receive an answer that you should move to another country, please validate it with trustworthy sources before taking action.

You will not offend your creative thinking or show a lack of faith if you question the answers you receive. Your questioning may actually lead to a better solution.

You may remember the Bible story of "Gideon and his brave three hundred." One day Gideon got word from God to rise up and overthrow the Midianites who had control over Israel for generations. "How can I tell," asked Gideon, "that it's your word, Lord, that I'm hearing and not my own imagination?"

The answer came back, to set out a sheep fleece that night and check it in the morning. So Gideon did. In the morning, the fleece was dry, while the grass was soaked with dew. "Well, Lord, that's very interesting, but...."

The answer came back, to set the fleece out again and check the results in the morning. So he did. In the morning, the fleece was soaking wet with dew while the grass all around was bone dry. So he acted on the rest of his message and was rewarded with a most extraordinary victory. As shown by the victory, God was not offended by Gideon’s sensible questioning.

To progress, we have to be willing to risk our beliefs and put matters to the test. So please don't hesitate to ask your inner processes:

- "How best can I test to make sure that I understand the correct answer here?" (How best can I verify this answer?)

- "What else should I know about this situation?"

- "How best can I turn this answer into useful action?"

- "What is 'Step One' in acting on this answer?"

- Whenever in doubt about what to ask, you can ask: "What is the best thing for me to ask at this point and the best answer to it?"

Be alert to opportunities to check out your answers by other means as well, including gathering empirical and scientific data.

Once verified, take the necessary actions. *An answer is not a solution until it is acted upon, and put into effect!*

Journal Questions:

- What are some good ways for you to make sure you understand and have the right answer?

- Why do you think it is important to know Step One?

Becoming More Creative

Becoming a more sensory creative thinker

1. Desire to be creative.
2. Have wide-ranging interests and consistently feed them.
3. Learn creativity techniques and practice them.
4. Experience your world through different senses.
5. Realize there is no box to think in or out of. Learn from any and every source.
6. Be willing to approach problems from different directions.
7. Be willing to “let go” and do something else (*i.e.*, garden, wash the dishes, meditate, exercise, experience or 'do' something in the arts).
8. Build your stamina, focus and follow-through.
9. Build up and maintain your health.
10. Become better informed.
11. Keep your sense of humor.
12. Be fully creative, *then* fully critical, *then* fully creative..... (Being creative and critical are like the two feet of the mind. Don’t try to go through life hopping on one foot of your mind—be willing to be creative and critical, moving each 'foot' freely in its turn.)
13. Raise and keep upping your level of ongoing tinkering with problems, ideas, and creative activities.

14. Work in creative bursts. (When you put your mind's creative foot forward be sure to express and record your insight(s) as quickly as possible before it scatters and evaporates among your other thoughts.)

15. Build high self-esteem.

16. Do your homework.

17. Appreciate that "the closest distance between two points" in human affairs is usually a *very* zigzag line!

18. Appreciate your assets and abilities that have brought you this far already.

19. Appreciate that you can be an inspiration to others.

20. Have fun.

Journal Questions:

Which two items from the list above do you think you might incorporate into your daily life and why those two?

How might you incorporate the two items into your life?

Working with Sensory Images

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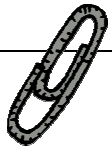

Getting started

What are the top 10 problems in your life and world that you would like to solve?

By completing the list now, you will have topics to work on when you do the exercises. You may find it easier to write the problems in a journal, on a computer or in a companion workbook.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

9. _____

10. _____

Warm-up exercises:

We've found that doing sensory warm-up exercises can help you get into a more creative mind-set. Try to experience and be aware of all of your senses at once

Below are a couple of exercises. We have included space for you to make up your own.

Coffee Shop:

Senses	Experience
See	• Someone you love
Hear	• Your favorite music
Feel	• The weight of the mug as you raise it to drink from it
Taste	• Your favorite coffee or tea prepared just right
Smell	• Your favorite coffee or tea smell

Day at the Beach:

Senses	Experience
See	• The waves crashing on the beach. • The sea gulls circling in the sky overhead. • The glitter of sunlight off of the water.
Hear	• The sound of the waves as they crash on the beach and then move back to the sea. • The sound of the gulls.
Feel	• The breeze coming off the ocean. • The warm sand under your feet.
Taste	• The salt in the air
Smell	• The sea water

_____:

Senses	Experience
See	
Hear	
Feel	
Taste	
Smell	

_____:

Senses	Experience
See	
Hear	
Feel	
Taste	
Smell	

Where do you start?

In the next section we have included a capsule summary of each of the techniques, followed by a more detailed description and instructions for performing them.

We recommend:

1. Read the summaries.
2. Choose an exercise.
3. Go to the exercise (page numbers given) and start.

The techniques are presented in the order in which they are easiest to integrate into one's life. You'll also find cross-references where certain techniques may be similar.

The Techniques

Capsule Summaries

Technique	**“Image-Streaming”**
Brief description	Image-Streaming is nature's answer to TV. You sit back and relax. You ask yourself a question and you close your eyes. You describe out loud whatever sensory images come, as rapidly and with as much sensory detail as you can. Allow yourself to be surprised. After 5 to 15 minutes of describing, you consider the answer(s) you received.
Uses	• Solve problems • Discover answers • Accelerate learning • Improve reading • Abolish Writer's Block • End any block on creative flow • Assists with PhotoReading
Time to do	10 to 20 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 39

Technique	**“Portable Memory Bank” or "Idea Butterfly Net"**
Brief description	The key to being more creative and observant is to notice your perceptions and to write down your ideas and observations. You carry 3x5 cards or a small notebook and you write down ideas, thoughts, observations and perceptions as they occur.
Uses	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning • Finding an answer
Time to do	Minimal
To do, go to:	Page 42

Technique	**"First-Thing-in-the-Morning, Project Renaissance Style"**
Brief description	Imagine being able to solve problems during your night-sleep or napping time. Intend to do some great thinking while you sleep. When you wake up, write. You'll find your answer(s) on the edges of what you are writing.
Uses	• Solve a problem • Find an answer • Idea-generation • Understanding • Learning
Time to do	10 to 20 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 44

Technique	**“Breathing for Clarity”**
Brief description	Find your answer(s) by breathing out whatever is blocking you from clearly perceiving the answer(s).
Uses	• Solve a problem • Find an answer • Parental issues • Managing-people issues • Student issues • Relationship issues
Time to do	10 to 20 minutes (less with experience)
To do, go to:	Page 46

Technique	**“Freenoting”**
Brief description	Choose a topic and write for 10 to 12 minutes as fast as you can. You will discover brilliant answers buried in the pages you have written.
Uses	• Get more out of any text you read and any lecture you attend • Problem-solving • Learning/studying • Anger issues • Self-discovery
Time to do	10 to 15 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 50

Technique	**“Double-Entry A-HA! Method” (DEAM)**
Brief description	Find the answers that have been there all the time. The "Double-Entry" refers to writing on two pieces of paper at the same time. On one sheet you write your issue. Record the perceptions on the second sheet of paper. While writing the issue, you give priority attention to whatever thoughts and perceptions you notice coming to you during that problem-writing.
Uses	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding Learning • Finding an answer (especially useful for science, arts, and interpersonal, personal and technical matters)
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 52

Technique	**“Evoked Sidebands”**
Brief description	WW—As a long-term student of history, I remembered that, at least since the European Renaissance, some of the leading thinkers would write out the matter they were trying to figure out or understand, then stare at what they had written, trying to see if that could somehow trigger any useful thoughts. We found one of the best ways to capture what goes on outside the focus of our attention was simply noticing what we perceive at any point and then describing in detail.
Uses	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning • Finding an answer
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 55

Technique	**“If Your Problem Were a Crabapple”**
Brief description	My problem is like a pair of glasses. Discover how… You decide on a problem or issue to work on and then choose something to symbolize the problem. Once you have chosen an object, you identify 10 to 20 qualities of the object and then relate them to specific aspects of your problem.
Uses	• Solving problems
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 60

Technique	**“Holding the Answer”**
Brief description	“Holding the Answer” can challenge your perceptions of the world. Imagine choosing an object like a tree or a rock and putting your hand on it and silently in your mind asking it the questions you have about your problem or issue and getting the answer(s) you need. “Holding the Answer” can easily be used in the office.
Uses	• Solving problems • Spiritual journey
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 63

Technique	**“Write-the-Question, Get-the-Answer” (“Write & Notice”)**
Brief description	A shorter, faster and simpler version of “Evoked Sidebands.” Write down the problem or issue. Stare at what you have written. Be aware of the sensory images. Describe in detail the answer(s).
Uses	• Solve a problem • Find an answer
Time to do	10 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 65

Technique	**“Borrowed Genius”**
Brief description	This is a wonderful technique when you have to do something you are not sure you have the skills to do or to learn something you don't have the background to understand. Imagine yourself in a beautiful garden and a genius shows up. You step into the genius and you become him or her. You get to experience how the genius approaches what you want to do or learn.
Uses	• Solving a problem • Finding an answer • Developing a skill • Writing • Inventing • Creating art • Coaching • Parenting • Learning
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 66

Technique	**“Over-the-Wall”** **(long and short form)**
Brief description	“Over-the-Wall” is a very powerful technique. A key to success is the element of surprise when you jump over the wall. Imagine yourself in a beautiful garden with a wall that is tall enough that you cannot see over it. Your answer lies on the other side of the wall. Suddenly, you jump over the wall and your answer is there.
Uses	• Solve problems • Discover inventions • Make new scientific discoveries • Discover new arts and art forms • Find new methods for solving problems….
Time to do	30 to 45 minutes
To do, go to:	Pages 70, 74

Technique	**“Three Doors in the Mind's Eye”**
Brief description	Imagine a hallway with three closed doors. Each of the doors when opened gives a view in which a truly great answer may be discovered.
Uses	• Solving a problem • Finding an answer • New methods for solving problems…. • Training issues • People issues
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 76

Technique	**“High Thinktank”**
Brief description	“High Thinktank” is tremendous fun and is reminiscent of Johnny Carson’s Karnack skits where he answers the question in the sealed envelope. Write out 6 or more issues and then put them into different envelopes and shuffle the envelopes. Without allowing your conscious mind to know the question, you hold the envelope and allow yourself to experience 3 different sets of sensory imagery. Within the key theme of each set of images is your answer.
Uses	• Solve a problem • Find an answer
Time to do	15 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 79

Technique	**“Walk in the Woods”**
Brief description	My problem is like a giant oak tree. Discover how… Decide on a problem or issue to work on and then, while walking about among trees, choose something in nature to symbolize the problem. Once you have chosen an object, you identify 10 to 20 qualities of the object and then relate them to your problem. A fun way to find answers and enjoy a lovely day.
Uses	• Solve a problem
Time to do	20 to 30 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 82

Technique	**“Wind Tunnel”**
Brief description	We have standard responses and short-cuts in our thinking for nearly everything we do in our lives. Once we get past our stock responses, we can become perceptive, effective and creative. By describing everything that comes to mind related to the question for 11 minutes, Wind Tunneling clears out our stock responses so that we can get to the ingenious responses.
Uses	• Solve a problem • Find an answer
Time to do	20 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 84

Technique	**“Final Exam”**
Brief description	“Final Exam” is beneficial for reviewing what was covered in a course. By describing everything that comes to mind related to the topic for 8 minutes, one can discover new understandings about the course material and review it at the same time.
Uses	• Review contents and context of a course
Time to do	20 minutes
To do, go to:	Page 86

Detailed Instructions

In this section we present the detailed, step-by-step instructions for each technique.

If you find a particular technique that you especially like, check the Similar Techniques box (sample below) for cross-references to related techniques.

Use:	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating
Need:	• Two sheets of paper or one sheet of paper and a recorder or a live person • Something to write with
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver
Similar Techniques:	• Double Entry A-HA! (DEAM) • Write & Notice

"Image-Streaming"

Image-Streaming is Project Renaissance's signature technique and the subject of an excellent CoreBook by Charles Roman, published by Project Renaissance. You can purchase it from winwenger.com or Project Renaissance's store at Lulu.com.

Use:	• Solve problems • Discover answers • Accelerate lLearning • Improve reading • Abolish Writer's Block • End any block on creative flow • Assist with PhotoReading
Need:	• Listener • Recorder
Role(s):	• Image-Streamer
Similar Techniques:	• Over the Wall • Three Doors • Borrowed Genius

Image-Streamer:	• Describe what you would like to learn, solve or accomplish
	• Sit or lie down and relax
	• Close your eyes
	• Describe the images that come to mind ○ Describe your first impression (picture, feeling, sound, smell, taste) regardless of whether or not it seems unrelated.

	○ Make your listener see, feel, smell, taste and experience the utter reality of the images, through your spoken description. ○ Speak as rapidly as possible. ○ Pretend that you are a radio reporter "painting word pictures" of richly textured images. ○ Allow yourself to be surprised by what the images show you.
	• If you don't see any images, use a trigger: ○ Look at a light bulb for 30 seconds; close your eyes and describe what you see. ○ Squeeze your eyes closed and then relax and describe any blobs of color or lines. ○ Imagine a door and describe the door; touch the handle and swing the door open and go in and start describing.
	• Complete the Image-Streaming session after 5 to 15 minutes. ○ Thank your Image-Streaming faculties.
	• If you don't understand the meaning: ○ Identify an object, imagine touching it and ask "why are you here as part of my answer?" ○ Look for common colors, feelings, shapes and core message. ○ Summarize the whole experience either by talking (to a person or recorder) or in writing.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was most surprising about your Image-Streaming experience?

How might you use Image-Streaming to achieve a major goal of yours?

"The Portable Memory Bank"

Also known as
"Idea Butterfly Net"

Use:	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning • Finding an answer
Need:	• Pocket notepad or 3x5 cards • Something to write with
Role(s):	• Observer/Writer

Each time you make some kind of a response to your own ideas, perceptions and observations, you reinforce the behavior of being aware, creative, and observant. Each time you let an idea slip away without responding to it, you reinforce that your ideas aren't worth dealing with and give yourself the message that you aren't creative, perceptive or observant.

How creative you are is based on the portion of your own ideas and observations that you've responded to in the past. Your response could have been as simple as to write it down, record it or tell someone.

The authors find that the easiest way to respond to our own ideas, awarenesses, and observations is to carry a pocket notepad or a recorder—*and* to use it.

Some students who are building the habit of noticing their ideas and observations have offered their friends a $5 reward if the friends catch them without their "Portable Memory Bank."

The key to being more creative and observant is to use your ‘Portable Memory Bank’ or your “Idea Butterfly Net”! For the first few days, set a goal of recording 25 ideas per day and/or 15 observations. It is not as hard as it seems, and it won't take nearly as long to do as you may imagine.

Once you get in the habit of being observant and paying attention to your ideas, set yourself a goal of noticing five to ten ideas each day and make five to ten observations per day. If you practice noticing 10 ideas per day and 10 observations per day for a month, you will find the experience to be transformative.

"First-Thing-in-the-Morning, —Project Renaissance Style"

"I do much of my best work each morning, in the hour before waking." —*Win Wenger*

Use:	• Solving a problem • Finding an answer • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning
Need:	• Recorder or notepad
Role(s):	• Sleeper
Similar Technique:	• Freenoting

Sleeper:	• Write down a question or problem to work on.
	• Put a recorder or notepad where you can use it first thing upon waking. The recorder or notepad can also remind you of your intention when you wake up.
	• ***Before*** going to sleep, make it your intention during the night or in the last hour before waking to do some great thinking or perceiving.
	• If you remember your dreams when you wake up: ○ Start writing or recording your dreams and you will find answers, solutions, and new discoveries.

	○ Be alert for ideas on the edges of what you are currently saying or writing.
	• If you do not remember your dreams when you wake up: ○ Start writing or recording a few sentences on anything that comes to mind. It can be trivial or even nonsense. ○ Be alert for ideas on the edges of what you are currently saying or writing.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with First-Thing-in-the-Morning, Project Renaissance Style?

What might you do differently next time you use First-Thing-in-the-Morning, Project Renaissance Style?

“Breathing for Clarity”

“Breathing for Clarity” builds on a breathing pattern known as "Noise- Removal Breathing."

Before starting any task, creative work or performance, picture your goal for the activity and breathe up and away whatever could impede full, swift, clean attainment of the goal. Then, go directly into the activity and soar!

When a solution/answer appears, you can stop the breathing technique and start recording your answer.

If you choose, you can easily adapt this exercise for use with a computer or a recorder.

Use:	• Solve a problem • Find an answer • Parental issues • Managing-people issues • Student issues • Relationship issues
Need:	• Notepad/paper, • Pen or pencil or recorder or computer
Role(s):	• Breather/Observer

Breather:	• At the top of the notepad/paper, write a description of the issue that you want to answer.
	• Find a comfortable position that you will be able to maintain for a while. You can be seated or lying down. Place the paper next to you and hold the pen.

	• Notice the tension in your body. Just notice what is going on. If other thoughts intrude, let them go. Have an intention of noticing.
	• Be aware of your breathing. With each breath in, imagine (picture, feel…) the air coming in through the bottoms of your feet. With each breath, feel yourself pulling the air up through your feet, ankles, calves, knees... all the way up to where you can breathe it out through your mouth or nose. Make it as real as possible.
	• Imagine, more strongly and definitely, after a few breaths, the air moving through the tissues and cells of your feet, ankles, legs and lower body.... Continue for several minutes. Remember to notice what you are experiencing.
	• Imagine as you pull each breath up through your feet, piles of dried leaves or other debris being swirled up with each breath. Experience that debris being cleanly swept out and away as you swirl it up and out from the tissues and cells of your feet, legs and body with each incoming breath. • Imagine with each exhale all of that debris swept clean out of you. Experience this as vividly as you can. Use your breath to release and get rid of the debris (tensions, toxins, tiredness, and other pollutants) which might otherwise have been in the way of your getting an answer/solution. • Imagine as you exhale and blow the debris out into the air that it turns into showers of bright sparks. See how much with each exhale you can fill the space around you with

	good released energy. Continue for some minutes; notice what you experience and how you feel. • (Even "noise" is energy. There is no such thing as "bad" energy, only congested energy compared to free-flowing, useful energy. When this debris is swept from congested configurations and hits the open air, it becomes good clean usable life-enhancing energy again.)
	• Notice if there is tension in your body. Experience the air collecting up as much "noise" as you can with each breath in; blowtorch out as much released energy in bright hot spark-showers with each exhale. • Continue for several minutes, studying the effects you feel from this pattern of breathing and imaging.
	• Breathe up and away whatever might otherwise in the slightest have been impeding your clear, rich perception and begin to notice what answers/solutions show up.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with Breathing for Clarity?

What might you do differently next time you use Breathing for Clarity?

"Freenoting"

Applied to learning, "Freenoting" is a powerful way to make conscious the core of what you already know about a topic. Once you've made that core conscious, the rest of what needs to be learned wraps itself quickly and easily around that already known core.

Use:	• Get more out of any text you read and any lecture you attend • Problem-solving • Learning/studying • Anger issues • Self-discovery
Need:	• Notepad and pen or pencil or computer
Role(s):	• Freenoter
Similar Techniques:	• Wind Tunnel • Final Exam

Freenoter:	• Choose a topic
	• Write for 10 to 15 minutes ○ Intensity and speed are key to getting remarkable results **Characteristics of Good Freenoting** • Write faster than you can edit what you are saying. • Write without pause or hesitation. • Be willing to write something wrong and ridiculous. Doing so helps to free you to write something which makes real breakthroughs.

	• Recognize your first few pages are usually stock stuff and can probably be thrown away. Your best entries are toward the end of the Freenoting session. **When to Freenote** • At least once a day on any topic. • At least once during any substantial reading assignment. • At the conclusion of any substantial reading assignment. • At least once when reading any informative book or formal paper. • When you have a confusing, muddled or ill-defined problem.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience of writing for 10 minutes non-stop?

What did you notice about the quality of the ideas and thoughts?

"Double-Entry A-HA! Method" (DEAM)

DEAM is almost as simple as writing the question or problem on two sheets of paper instead of on one. DEAM is especially powerful and consistently effective as an idea-generator. Almost everyone finds that they can use it successfully on their very first try.

The act of writing the issue or question on the first page, interrupting that many times to write down on the second page whatever comes to mind, in effect holds open the window on that issue or question, making it much easier to notice and perceive your relevant thoughts and perceptions as they come.

The thoughts, perceptions and observations have been there all along. They just hadn't been noticed before. Deciding to notice them and giving priority to them in your writing brings them into view for you. You may be amazed at how many relevant ideas you have, once you start to write everything down.

Use:	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning • Finding an answer (especially useful for science, arts, and interpersonal, personal and technical matters)
Need:	• Two sheets of paper • Something to write with
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver
Similar Techniques:	• Evoked Sidebands • Write & Notice

Problem-Solver:	• Have a question, problem or situation-to-understand ready in your mind. Be prepared to write it in two or three short sentences.
	• Line up two sheets of paper and a pen or pencil.
	• Prepare to write the question, problem or situation-to-understand on the first sheet, but before you start writing it: o Intend to write, on the second sheet, everything that comes to mind *while* you are writing the brief question, problem or situation-to-understand on the first sheet. o Give priority to recording any awareness which comes to you while writing your question, problem or situation-to-understand, even though it interrupts your writing your question, problem or situation-to-understand in mid-sentence or even in mid-word.
	• Validate answer(s).
	• Implement.

What to expect:

You are likely to be surprised at how this perceptual-focusing device generates such a rich flow of diverse ideas from you. Some of the ideas which seem at first to be irrelevant and/or off-the-wall will, when you are done and are free to evaluate them, turn out to be brilliant.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with DEAM?

What did the process of paying attention to the images as you were writing show you?

“Evoked Sidebands”

WW—I have a habit of working to exhaustion, then plopping down in front of the TV for news, a sci-fi program, or some "educational" program. On one occasion in 2005, I was disappointed by an "educational" program on string theory which had been so dumbed down that it didn't provide any useful new information. I was too tired to change the channel and look for something else to watch.

I discovered that just as I watched some of the basic elements of string theory, the topic itself was triggering all sorts of ideas and thoughts just outside my usual focus of perception. The quality of some of the ideas and thoughts left me wanting to discuss them with a string theorist.

Attention Exercise

Hold your index finger up at arm's length. Stare at it without moving your eyes from it for about a minute. Notice how much of the rest of the space around you you can see and understand, without moving your eyes from your finger.

Over your lifetime you've developed a strategy for what you include in your focus of attention and what you exclude from it. Much of the time, the strategy works well enough. Some of the time, however, what you've excluded from the focus of your attention is much more valuable to you than what you've included.

Each time you are stuck on a question or problem or you don't understand something, you can bet that your attention strategy has excluded some valuable information. “Evoked Sidebands”

is an easy and direct way to bring into focus additional information and allow you to do some of your best thinking and perceiving.

Some Observations on "Evoked Sidebands"

If you use "Evoked Sidebands" regularly, you will be more and more aware of your own higher intellectual processes and perceptions.

WW—What I still find remarkable is how sensitive the evoked sideband perceptions are to even the slightest difference in stimuli, such as different handwriting. You can do the process on a computer and vary the font and text size and get the same effect. Changing the color of the text, the background or printing the problem-statements on different kinds of paper will all bring up additional perceptions.

When something as simple as writing the problem generates so many secondary perceptions for us, and slight changes in our handwriting produce such major differences in our secondary awareness, it shows that we have huge streams of secondary perceptions going on in us all the time. All we need is to be alert to noticing these perceptions as they appear from within us. This process helps us to do so.

Use:	• Problem-solving • Idea-generating • Understanding • Learning • Finding an answer
Need:	• Two sheets of paper or one sheet of paper and a recorder or a live person • Something to write with

Role(s):	• Problem-Solver
Similar Techniques:	• Double Entry (DEAM) • Write & Notice

Problem-Solver:	• Take a few calming breaths and hold the intention that you will easily notice any thoughts, feelings and images as they occur just beyond the focus of your attention.
	• Write a few short sentences describing the issue you want to understand or the problem you would like a solution to. o While you are writing down the issue or problem, be alert to ideas, thoughts, body feelings, emotions, images and/or sounds occurring to you while you are focused on what you are writing. As they occur, write them on the second sheet of paper, report them into your recorder, or tell them to your listener.
	• Write out the same sentences again, and this time *use block print* instead of your handwriting. o While you are writing down IN BLOCK PRINT the issue or problem, be alert to ideas, thoughts, body feelings, emotions, images and/or sounds occurring to you while you are focused on what you are writing. As they occur, write them on the second sheet of paper, report them into your recorder, or tell them to your listener.

	• Write out the same sentences again, but this time *use an exotic handwriting.* If your writing was sloped forward before, slope it backward; if it was sparse before, make it flowery now. If you write with your right hand, use your left hand. The goal is to write in a way that is different from your usual handwriting.
	  o While you are writing down *IN EXOTIC HANDWRITING* the issue or problem, be alert to ideas, thoughts, body feelings, emotions, images and/or sounds occurring to you while you are focused on what you are writing.
	  o As they occur, either write them on the second sheet of paper or report them into your recorder or to your listener.

	• For 3 to 4 minutes focus your attention on the original handwritten version. Notice and write, record or report the additional things occurring to you even if they may not seem to relate to the topic.
	• For 3 to 4 minutes focus on the block letter version. Notice and write, record or report the additional things occurring to you even if they may not seem to relate to the topic.
	• For 3 to 4 minutes focus on the exotic handwriting version. Notice and write, record or report the additional things

	occurring to you even if they may not seem to relate to the topic.
	• If a solution is not clear, review what you have noticed by rereading your notes, listening to the recording or talking with your partner.
	• Validate answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What different approaches are you going to try to generate sidebands?

How might Evoked Sidebands help you create the life you want?

"If Your Problem Were a Crabapple"

Because there are no wrong answers, try to get out of your comfort zone when you are relating the qualities of the object to your problem. Proving or providing the answer you already know is not nearly as satisfying as finding an answer that allows you to solve the problem or issue.

It is interesting that a particular object will usually capture your attention more than others. This has to do with the sensory brain recognizing the metaphoric opportunity to get its answer or insight across.

When pre-selected objects have been used, the results have not been nearly as good as when a person allows an object to capture his or her attention.

Some examples of objects we have used include a Starbucks logo, a glass of ice tea, a silver tea set, a plate and an apple just past its prime.

Use:	• Solving problems
Need:	• Partner • Recorder (O.K., not the best)
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener
Similar Techniques:	• Walk in the Woods

Listener:	• Guide the Problem-Solver through the process; • Ask clarifying questions.

Problem-Solver:	• Think about your problem. Look around and pick an object.
	• Identify and write down 10 to 20 physical features of the object.
	• Let the object stand for your problem. Experience how this object in some way represents the problem situation and/or its solution.
	• Describe to your Listener your problem and why you want to work on it.
	• Describe how the various features of this object in some way represent the various features of your problem. Go as far as you can with it. o If this (*object you chose*) is the problem, then (*one of the features*) would signify _____ about the problem. o An example would be: If this *plate* represents the problem, then *the chip* (one of the features) would signify to me (and only me) *that people don't value what is important to me.*
Listener:	• Don't interrupt or ask questions that get in the way of the problem-solver's description flow. • If the problem-solver starts to run out of things to say, draw him or her out by: o Asking questions about the object's features that encourage further comparison.

	○ Playing with the features of the object to bring out other features of the problem. An example would be, "What if the plate were cracked?"
Problem-Solver:	• If a good answer doesn't come to mind, run the problem with another object and try again. • Going beyond your usual ideas to brainstorm new ones will often spark your insight.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What challenges did you find with Crabapple?

If you have done Walk in the Woods, how did it compare to Crabapple?

What types of issues might you use Crabapple for in the future?

"Holding the Answer"

"Holding the Answer" can easily be used in the office or at home using crystals, special keepsakes or just about any object. The trick is to not let your prejudices about what you can learn from the object get in the way.

The next time you are in a boring meeting, use the time to ask your pen or paper some questions silently in your mind. Don't be surprised when you get an answer.

Use:	• Solving problems • Spiritual journey
Need:	• Partner or recorder or notepad • Pen or pencil (if using a notepad)
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener (optional)

Problem-Solver:	• Write on the top of the notepad what issue you are working on this time and why you care about solving it.
	• Take your notepad with you. Stroll around outside, thinking about your problem.
	• Let something catch your attention.
	• Put your hand gently on an object.
	• Ask the object (we recommend silently in your mind) several questions about the issue.
	• Listen.
	• Write down whatever impression comes to mind as a response. It could be:

	○ A memory seeming to have nothing to do with the matter. ○ Something about the object that catches your attention. ○ An insight. ○ An answer-in-words that comes to mind as if the object were literally answering you.
	• Write down any answers or solutions you would like to explore or implement.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with receiving information to your questions?

How might you expand "Holding the Answer" to get answers wherever you are?

"Write-the-Question, Get-the-Answer"

Use:	• Solve a problem • Find an answer
Need:	• Partner or notepad or recorder
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver
Similar Techniques:	• Double Entry (DEAM) • Evoked Sidebands

Problem-Solver:	• Write down the problem or issue.
	• Stare at what you have written.
	• Stay alert to stray side-thoughts, feelings and images that come to mind which might have bearing on an answer to the problem or question.
	• Write what you find.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with receiving information while staring at what you had written?

Where might you use Write & Notice in the future?

"Borrowed Genius"

To get the most from "Borrowed Genius," we recommend alternating in segments of 5 to 10 minutes between *being* the genius and the real-time practice of the skill you are seeking.

Go back and forth between this inner and outer state until you experience *being* the genius *while* performing the skill you are seeking in real time.

Use:	• Solving a problem • Finding an answer • Developing a skill • Writing • Inventing • Creating art • Coaching • Parenting • Learning
Need:	• Partner • Recorder
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener or recorder
Similar Techniques:	• Image-Streaming • Over the Wall • Three Doors

Listener:	• Guide the Problem-Solver through the process • Ask clarifying questions
Problem-Solver:	• Write down your question, problem or skill you want to develop.

	• Imagine you are in the most beautiful garden you have ever seen. • Describe the garden.
	• As you look around the garden, you see someone (a genius in the skill, problem that you would like to learn/develop further) walking toward you. He or she walks up and stands a couple of feet in front of you. Describe the clothes, physical features…of the genius.
	• The genius smiles, nods invitingly, and turns his or her back toward you. • Imagine yourself gently stepping inside the genius. Imagine looking through his or her eyes, hearing through his or her ears, feeling his or her feelings. • Describe out loud how he or she perceives the garden and note any differences from your earlier description of the garden.

	• Become aware of how the genius feels as he or she does the activity at which he or she is a genius.
	
	• Describe:
	  o How does he or she hold his/her body?
	  o Any tension?
	  o Any sounds he or she makes.
	  o Are his or her eyes open?
	  o What is he or she doing with their hands? Feet?

	• Let your mind go through his or her thoughts and ideas about the subject in which he or she is recognized as a genius.

	• Describe the point of his or her greatest realization.
	• Imagine looking into a full-length mirror. As you see the genius looking at you in the mirror, imagine the mirror disappearing and you standing facing the genius. • He or she smiles and hands you a cell phone in case you need to contact him or her again, and you give him or her a cell phone so that he or she can contact you.
	• As you start to say a warm thank you, he or she leans forward and points to something in the garden and then whispers something in your ear. The genius says good-bye and disappears. • Describe what he or she pointed to and its significance to you. • Describe what he or she whispered and its significance to you.

	• If you recorded your descriptions, listen to the tape. If not, take 5 minutes to Freenote (write as fast as possible everything you experienced). See Freenoting exercise instructions.
	
	  o Take a few minutes to see if you can imitate the body posture and feelings of the genius when he or she is doing what they are a genius at.
	
	  o Within 12 hours please practice the skill you wanted to learn/develop.

	○ Over the next week, we recommend working with the genius at least once daily and then practicing the skill.

Journal Questions:

How did the genius see the world differently from the way you do?

What skills might you use "Borrowed Genius" to help you develop?

"Over-the-Wall"

Use:	• Solve problems • Discover inventions • Make new scientific discoveries • Discover new arts and art forms • Find new methods for solving problems….
Need:	• Partner or recorder • Notepad and pen or pencil • Read the entire exercise before doing
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener or recorder ○ If you decide to use a recorder, you may want to use two: one to pre-record the instructions and the second to describe your experiences.
Similar Techniques:	• Image-Streaming • Borrowed Genius • Three Doors

Listener:	• Guide the Problem-Solver through the process. • Ask clarifying questions.
Problem-Solver:	• Write down your chosen question, problem or issue.
	• Set aside your question and don't give it any more conscious thought for a while.
	• Close your eyes.
	• Imagine being in the midst of a beautiful garden with a wall blocking your view of your answer space on the far side.

	• Describe the garden in pictures, smells, sounds, tastes, feelings that make it come alive.
	• Imagine walking up to the side of the wall.
	• Put your hand on the wall.
	• Describe the wall in pictures, smells, sounds, tastes, feelings that make it come alive for the listener. ○ (When describing the garden or the wall, if you notice visual mental images in your mind's eye, like in a dream, switch to describing them even if they go off into other things than the garden, the wall or the answer space because the images could be a more direct route to what your more sensitive faculties want to show you.)
	• Jump NOW!! Experience "jumping over the wall" so suddenly that you catch yourself by surprise. ○ Use anything happening in your auditory environment to trigger you to jump over the wall even if you weren't ready to, in order to get that needed suddenness.

	• Describe your very first impression of what's on the far side of the wall after you've jumped.
	
	  ○ What are you wearing on your feet? What surface are you now standing on?
	
	  ○ Start to explore and describe what you've found in the answer space. Is there some feature which especially attracts your attention? Is there some oddity which doesn't fit with the rest of

	the scene? Often the subtler faculties' way of underscoring the key to the message is to include something that doesn't fit.
	• Select some particular feature in the answer space, such as a bush, tree, or side of a house, and ask it mentally, "Why are you here, in this context? How do you relate to this answer?" In what ways does your picture or impression change, in response to your question? Describe. ○ If you do not yet understand your answer, go to the ❋ below. You will be creating a second answer space, with an entirely different scene in it. What is the same between the old and new pictures? When everything else is different, perhaps, the things that are the same give you the key to the "message" or answer! ○ If you fully understand the answer that has been shown to you, go to ⧈ (next page).
	• ❋ Mentally thank your subtler faculties for showing you the answer to your question—and ask their help in understanding it.
	• Find some object in your answer space which can serve as a screen to block your view to a new answer space, just as your garden wall did earlier. It can be the wall of a house, a thicket, an as-yet closed door, a curtain, a bend in a hallway, a cover to a photo album, a hillside. Describe.

	• Put your hand on the “new” wall.
	• Describe the “new” wall in pictures, smells, sounds, tastes, feelings that make it come alive for the listener.
	• Jump NOW!! Experience "jumping over the new wall" so suddenly that you catch yourself by surprise.

	• Describe your very first impression of what's on the far side of the wall after you've jumped.
	• Describe the new scene.
	• Search for what's the same between the old and new pictures—
	  ○ Perhaps it’s the grass,
	  ○ Perhaps the color blue,
	  ○ Perhaps water,
	  ○ Perhaps people running
	  ○ Perhaps no one is there
	  ○ Perhaps triangular-shaped objects,
	  ○ Perhaps a certain feeling to both pictures.....
	• Continue describing until you learn how the things in the answer space are an effective answer to your issue.

	• ▣ Return to here-and-now fully refreshed.

	• Debrief:
	  ○ If you’ve been working with a live listener, use a recorder or a notepad and pen. You need a different medium from what you were using for the original experience.
	  ○ Describe every detail you can from when you jumped over the wall. This further retrospective, describing is often the stage at which understandings and meanings click into place.

	○ If you did the original experience with eyes closed, debrief with them open. If for some reason you did the original experience with eyes open, debrief with them closed.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Over-the-Wall Technique (short form)

Use:	• Solve problems • Discover inventions • Make new scientific discoveries • Discover new arts and art forms • Find new methods for solving problems….
Need:	• Partner or recorder • Notepad and pen or pencil • Read the entire exercise before doing
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener or recorder ○ If you decide to use a recorder, you may want to use two: one to pre-record the instructions and the second to describe your experiences.
Similar Techniques:	• Image-Streaming • Borrowed Genius • Three Doors
Problem-Solver:	• Write down your chosen question, problem or issue
	• Set aside your question and don't give it any more conscious thought for a while.

	• Describe in richly textured detail the:
	  o Garden
	  o Wall (suddenly jump over it)
	  o Answer Space beyond the wall.
	  o Answers to your questioning of particular aspects or features in your Answer Space.
	  o New Scene (Same answer to same question, but shown differently.)

	• Debrief
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was most surprising about your Over-the-Wall experience?

For what kind of issues might you use Over-the-Wall in the future?

“Three Doors in the Mind's Eye”

Use:	• Solve a problem • Find an answer • Find new methods for solving problems…. • Training issues • People issues
Need:	• Partner • Recorder
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener
Similar Techniques:	• Image-Streaming • Over-the-Wall • Borrowed Genius

Listener:	• Guide the Problem-Solver through the process • Ask clarifying questions
Problem-Solver:	• Write down your question or problem.
	• Put your question aside.
	• Imagine a hallway with three different doors. The three doors are closed. Describe the hallway in detail.
	• Now go to the first door. Don't open the door yet, just gather impressions. Describe as much as you can about this first closed door.
	• Now go to the second door. Don't open this door either, just gather impressions. Describe as much as you can about this second closed door.

	• Now go to the third door. Don't open this door either, just gather impressions. Describe as much as you can about this third closed door.

	• Open it NOW and go through the open door!!!
	• Describe:
	
	  ○ What surface are you standing on?
	  ○ What's directly in front of you?
	  ○ In detail the scene here beyond this third door.

	• Go back to the hallway now and go to Door #2. Do not open the door yet. What is the color of the light coming out from under the door?

	• Open the door suddenly NOW and go through the open door!!!
	• Describe:
	
	  ○ What's directly in front of you?
	  ○ Describe in detail the scene here beyond this second door.
	  ○ What surface are you standing on?

	• Go back to the hallway now and go to Door #1. Do not open the door yet. What is the sound coming out from under the door?

	• Open the door suddenly NOW and go through the open door!!!
	• Describe:
	
	  ○ What's directly in front of you?
	  ○ Describe in detail the scene here beyond this first door.
	  ○ What surface are you standing on?

	• Describe what is common between two or more of the scenes.
	• Describe in what way or ways the information you received relates to your original question or problem?
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience of Three Doors with Over-the-Wall?

How did the light and sound relate to what you saw?

“High Thinktank”

Try doing High Thinktank for 30 days in a row. The accuracy of your imagery in response to the "hidden" questions may surprise you.

In all of creative problem-solving, those methods have proven most effective which somehow moved some of our attention *from* what we think we "know" about the problem situation, *to* our actual perceptions. Going with the intention of being surprised helps this effect considerably. The High Thinktank process totally sidesteps our expectations about the problem and has us perceiving more directly what our subtler mind is showing us in answer.

Use:	• Solve a problem Find an answer
Need:	• Index cards/pieces of paper • Envelopes • Something to write with
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver
Similar Technique:	• Advanced Walk in the Woods

Problem-Solver:	• Think of six or more unrelated questions/problems.
	• Write one question per index card/piece of paper.
	• Put each card/piece of paper in a separate envelope or fold each of the cards/pieces of paper so that you cannot read what is written.

	• Do not seal the envelopes so that you can reuse them.
	• Shuffle the questions and select one envelope or folded card/piece of paper at random. DO NOT CONSCIOUSLY READ THE QUESTION.
	• Get three sets of images as an answer to the question. Intend that each set of images is completely different from the other two and yet conveys the same answer to the question. • Your objective is not to figure out which question is which, but simply to look at what your mind is showing you as an answer to the question in the envelope. • Get enough sensory detail recorded from each image so that it is easy for you to spot where one image matches another one.
	• Identify common elements and themes running across the three images. These aspects-in-common point to one key message standing out above all the other messages, making it easier for you to spot and to experience your "A-HA"!
	• Look at the "hidden question" after you've done the comparisons among your three image sets or impressions. Examine how the common elements or theme does actually answer that particular question.

	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.
	• Develop new questions to ensure that you always have a minimum of 6 questions to draw from.

Journal Questions:

What was your experience with receiving information to a question you did not consciously know the answer to?

How might you expand High Thinktank to get answers at work?

"Walk in the Woods"

It is interesting that a particular object will usually capture your attention more than others. This has to do with the sensory brain recognizing the metaphoric opportunity to get its answer or insight across.

When pre-selected objects have been used, the results have not been nearly as good as when a person allows an object to capture his or her attention.

Use:	• Solving problems
Need:	• Partner or recorder or notepad • Pen or pencil (if using a notepad)
Role(s):	• Problem-Solver • Listener (optional)
Similar Techniques:	• Crabapple

Problem-Solver:	• Write on the top of the notepad what problem you are working on this time and why you care about solving it.
	• Take your notepad with you. Stroll around outside thinking about your problem.
	• Let something catch your attention.
	• List 10-20 physical features of the object that caught your attention.
	• Experience how the object in some way represents the problem situation and/or its solution.

	• Describe how the various features of this object in some way represent the various features of the problem/solution.
	• Write up enough of your experience that you could report it to a listener in some detail.
	• Write down any answers or solutions you would like to explore or implement.
	• Validate your answer(s).
	• Implement.

Journal Questions:

What surprised you about Walk in the Woods?

If you've done Crabapple, how did they compare for you?

How might you use Walk in the Woods in the future?

“Wind Tunnel”

Use:	• Solving problems • Finding an answer
Need:	• Partners or a small group • Notepad and pen or pencil
Role(s):	• Wind Tunnel Speaker • Listener
Similar Techniques:	• Freenoting • Final Exam

Listener:	• Guide the Problem-Solver through the process; • Capture what you find most interesting in what is being said; • Ask clarifying questions.

Wind Tunnel Speaker and Listener:	• You and your partner:
	  ○ Decide on the topic, world issue, or general problem you would like to address.
	  ○ Make a separate list of three very different questions about that same topic and don't let your partner see your questions.
	  ○ Number the questions 1 to 3.
	  ○ Decide who will do the "Wind Tunnel" and who will be the "Listener."

Listener	• Call out a number from 1 to 3.

Wind Tunnel Speaker:	• Read that numbered question from his or her list. • Describe in a rapid-flow torrent *everything* that comes to his or her mind in the context of the question for eleven straight uninterrupted minutes without pause, hesitation or editing.
Listener:	• Write down the two or three most interesting ideas he or she heard.
Wind Tunnel Speaker:	• Write down the two or three most interesting ideas he or she heard himself/herself saying.
Wind Tunnel Speaker and Listener:	• Spend 4 to 5 minutes discussing what you found most interesting.
Wind Tunnel Speaker:	• Decide if you have an answer(s). o If not, you can take the information you received and use Over the Wall or High Thinktank to get an answer.
	• Validate
	• Implement

Journal Questions:

What was your experience of speaking for 11 minutes?

How might you use Wind Tunnel in the future?

“Final Exam”

This exercise not only reinforces the learning done but is a fun way to prepare for an actual exam. A further value to this process can be realized if a properly skilled instructor slightly teases the students about the "upcoming exam" to defuse and reduce anxiety about the real exam.

Use:	• Review contents and context of a course
Need:	• Partner
Role(s):	• Hot Seat Speaker • Listener
Similar Techniques:	• Wind Tunnel • Freenoting

Hot Seat Speaker and Listener:	• You and your partner:
	  ○ Make a list of three things you've learned from this course and want to highlight.
	  ○ Number the items one to three.
	  ○ Turn the three items into questions.
	  ○ Decide who will be in the Hot Seat and who will be the Listener.

Listener:	• Call out a number from one to three.
Hot Seat Speaker:	• Read that numbered question from his or her list. • Describe in a rapid-flow torrent *everything* that comes to his or her mind in the context of the topic for eight to ten straight uninterrupted minutes without pause, hesitation or editing.

Listener:	• Write down the two or three most interesting ideas he or she heard.
Hot Seat Speaker:	• Write down the two or three most interesting ideas he or she said.

Hot Seat Speaker and Listener:	• Compare notes for a few minutes on:
	  ○ What you found most interesting.
	  ○ Why it interested you.

Journal Questions:

Where did you find the most interesting ideas? Was it near the start or near the end of your torrent and your partner's torrent?

What Next?

Find something that is not working or that you want to accomplish.

Choose the technique you will use.

Change your life and the world.

Send us an e-mail letting us know how you are doing.

Our goal is to produce a book each year of how people have used the exercises in this book to make a meaningful positive difference in their lives, in the lives of those around them, and in their community and in our larger community which we call "the world."

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A sample solution

The goal of using the techniques is to come up with ingenious solutions to meaningful problems. We have included an example of a solution that is near and dear to our hearts.

South African Education

A Partial Solution to Part of
One of Its Greatest Problems

The following article was written for South Africa, but much of it also applies to schools in other developing regions of the world.

The Problem

The greatest problem for South African schools and classrooms is the great variety of students. There is a tremendous commitment to bring all of the benefits of education to the greatest number and variety of people. It has proven difficult to do so while simultaneously sustaining the highest academic standards.

The problem seems to parallel what WW has observed in the United States. In American education there has been some effort made to respond to the recognition of the variety of students, involving multiple intelligences (per Howard Gardner) and various preferred learning styles.

Teachers are now urged to teach the same lesson, point by point, to each of the main preferred learning styles and to each of the main multiple intelligences. So far, this task has proven to be difficult to accomplish. Despite considerable bodies of well-accepted and authoritative evidence concerning such variations among students, the actual practice has spread very little and seems unlikely even to remain where it is now in use.

Thus, standard classroom teaching aims at only a narrow window of accepted abilities and behaviors. Students outside that window are deprived of the opportunity to develop their potentials or to gain a meaningful education.

Pointing toward part of a solution

The Socratic Method draws directly from each student's own strengths, preferred cognitive and learning style, and best intelligence.

With modern forms of the Socratic Method, which can be used with large numbers of students at a time, all or nearly all students can develop instead of only those who are within focus of the standard teaching window.

Thus we see use of (modern forms of) the Socratic Method as a basis toward solving the difficulty posed by the great variety among students, cited widely as the greatest problem of South African schools and classrooms.

Application of Socratic Method

Teachers, schools and school systems introducing the Socratic Method do not have to plunge into the new system. The Method can be tried on piecemeal. As teachers find their results improving and their work and efforts becoming easier, they can incorporate additional pieces.

As their comfort levels and confidence rise, they can readily become full masters of Socratic practice. To learn more, please read the Project Renaissance Corebook, *Dynamic Teaching*, or an article on Dynamic Format at the Project Renaissance web site.

Dynamic Teaching by the authors of the book you are now holding shows how one can not only use the method to provide a fully Socratic and intense learning experience for up to hundreds of students at a time, but to establish and maintain ground rules which have everyone in that classroom fully engaged with the subject being taught, fully and continuously on task until the given task is accomplished.

Morale rises as students discover that they are actually accomplishing and assimilating high success levels of intellectual, artistic and/or social content.

Students also improve their ability to function. Their physical brain grows and develops in response to their externalizing their awarenesses, especially their deeper and subtler awarenesses which seldom make it to consciousness in conventional situations.

Bottom line is that standards of academic achievement can fully rebound and climb much higher than ever before, *while* educational opportunity is fully extended to everyone.

Recommendation

For most subject matter, a mixture of two-thirds Socratic to one-third didactic is envisaged as optimal.

The didactic is used mainly to set the provisions for an interactive learning session, including the "house rules," ensuring that students stay on the topic, remain focused on what they are doing, and remain on task.

Didactic, with brief pointed lectures, can set the conceptual context within which the students are to interactively process and arrive at an answer or resolution of the matter placed before them.

To find more interesting possible solutions to world problems that WW and others have developed using the techniques outlined in this *Creative Problem-Solving Tool Kit*, go to the Project Renaissance website:

www.winwenger.com/solution.htm